

Client Demo Runbook

A 12-minute live walkthrough proving that adding one tag to a product puts it into the right category — for Shop by Colour, Shop by Occasion and Shop by Style.

1. What you are proving, and the running order
2. Prep — 15 minutes, the day before
3. Act 1 — Shop by Colour (no setup needed)
4. Act 2 — Shop by Occasion (build a category live)
5. Act 3 — Shop by Style
6. If something does not appear — live recovery
7. Rollback after the demo
8. Questions the client will ask

1. What you are proving, and the running order

One sentence, repeated three times in three different places:

SAY

"You never touch the website. You add a tag to the product, and the product files itself into the right place on the storefront — instantly."

ACT	SECTION	WHAT THE CLIENT WATCHES	PREP NEEDED
1	Shop by Colour	A platter with no colour in its name appears under the Copper swatch	NONE
2	Shop by Occasion	A brand-new Eid category goes from 0 to 3 products	5 MIN
3	Shop by Style	The Earthy category goes from 12 to 13 products	2 MIN

Set the room up first. You need two browser tabs side by side, ideally on one screen:

- **Tab A — Shopify admin**, already logged in, on the Products list.
- **Tab B — the live storefront**, `thehomepalette.com.pk`.

The client should be able to see both. The whole demo is: change something in Tab A, refresh Tab B, point at the result.

Always hard-refresh Tab B — **Cmd+Shift+R** (Mac) or **Ctrl+F5** (Windows). A normal refresh can serve a cached page and make a working demo look broken.

2. Prep — 15 minutes, the day before

2.1 Do a full dry run

Run all three acts exactly as written, then roll everything back (section 7). Do not let the client's session be the first time you run this.

2.2 Point the homepage cards at the right collections

This is the one thing that will quietly break the demo. Today the homepage **Shop by Occasion** cards and **Shop by Style** tiles link to older manual collections, not the tag-driven ones. The Tea Time card, for example, goes to *Tea & Coffee Cups* rather than the tag-driven *Tea Time* collection.

- 1 Online Store → **Themes**. On the live theme choose **Duplicate**, then **Customize** the copy. Do the demo on the copy — the live site stays untouched until the client says yes.
- 2 Open the **THP Shop by Occasion** section. Click each card block and **clear the "Custom link" field**, then set **Collection** to the matching tag-driven collection. The custom link overrides the collection, and five of the six cards have one set.
- 3 Open **THP Shop by Style**. Set the **Earthy** tile's collection to **Earthy** and the **Reactive** tile's to **Reactive**. Leave the Link field empty.
- 4 **Save**. Use the theme preview URL for Tab B during the demo.

Short on time? Skip this and run every act on the collection URL directly (`/collections/earthy` , `/collections/eid`). The proof is identical — you just lose the homepage card as the visual. Act 1 works on the homepage either way.

2.3 Create nothing else yet

Leave the **Eid** collection uncreated. Building it live in front of the client is the strongest moment in the demo.

2.4 Pre-flight checklist

- ☐ Logged into Shopify admin, admin tab open on Products
- ☐ Storefront (or theme preview) open in a second tab
- ☐ Dry run completed and rolled back
- ☐ The four demo products confirmed in stock and published (table in section 3 and 4)
- ☐ This runbook open on your phone or a printout

Act 1 — Shop by Colour

~3 minutes · no setup · the tag takes effect the second you hit Save

The product: Arabic Mandi Platter — handle `arabic-mandi-platter`, 53 in stock, published, sits in New Arrivals / THP Metalware / Shop.

Why this one: its name contains no colour, and it has no colour variant option. So today it appears under **no swatch at all** — which is exactly the problem tags solve.

Run it

- 1 **Tab B:** homepage → scroll to **Shop by Colour** → click the **Copper** swatch. Three copper pieces show. The Mandi platter is not one of them.
- 2 Say the line below, then switch to Tab A.
- 3 **Tab A:** Products → search *Arabic Mandi Platter* → open it.

- 4 Right-hand column → **Product organization** → **Tags** field.
- 5 Type **copper** and press **Enter**. Let the client see the chip appear.
- 6 Click **Save**.
- 7 **Tab B:** hard-refresh, click **Copper** again. The Arabic Mandi Platter is now in the grid.

SAY

"This platter is copper, but the word 'copper' isn't in its name — so the site has no way of knowing. Watch. I add one word to the product, and it joins the copper palette. No developer, no code, no waiting."

The point to land — Shop by Colour does not use collections at all. The theme reads the tag straight off the product, so there is nothing to set up and no delay. This is the fastest, most reliable act; that is why it goes first.

Do not pick a product that has a Color variant option for this act. If a product sells in several colours from one listing, the theme uses the variant option and ignores colour tags entirely — the tag will appear to do nothing. The Arabic Mandi Platter's only option is size, which is why it was chosen.

Act 2 — Shop by Occasion

~5 minutes · you build a brand-new category from nothing, live

This is the centrepiece. The client watches an empty **Eid** category fill up.

Step A — create the category (2 min)

- 1 **Tab A:** Products → **Collections** → **Create collection**.
- 2 **Title:** `Eid`
- 3 Collection type → **Automated**.
- 4 Products must match: **all conditions**.
- 5 Condition: **Product tag** · **is equal to** · `occasion-eid`
- 6 **Save**. Point at the panel: **0 products**.

SAY

"I've just created the Eid category. It's empty, and notice I never picked a single product — I told it a rule: anything tagged 'occasion-eid' belongs here. Now let me put things in it, without ever coming back to this screen."

Step B — tag three products (3 min)

All three are verified published and in stock. Open each, add the tag, Save.

PRODUCT	TAG TO ADD	IN STOCK
Golden Luxe Cutlery Set - 24 Pcs	<code>occasion-eid</code>	131
Matte Gold Premium Cutlery Set	<code>occasion-eid</code>	7
Arabic Mandi Platter	<code>occasion-eid</code>	53

Use the Arabic Mandi Platter last, and say this:

"This is the same platter I tagged copper two minutes ago. It now carries both tags — it's in the copper palette and in the Eid category at the same time. A product can live in as many categories as it genuinely belongs to."

Faster alternative: in the Products list, tick all three checkboxes → **Add tags** in the bar at the top → type `occasion-eid` → **Apply changes**. One action, three products. Use this if you are running short on time.

Step C — show the result

- 1 **Tab A:** back to Collections → **Eid**. It now reads **3 products**. It filled itself.
- 2 **Tab B:** open `thehomepalette.com.pk/collections/eid` — the three products are live on the storefront.
- 3 If you did prep 2.2: go to the homepage instead and show the **Eid** card under Shop by Occasion. Its product count is live and now reads **3 varieties**.

SAY

"That's a new shopping category, built and populated, in five minutes, with no developer involved. Ramadan, Wedding Gifts, Hosting Guests — all of them work exactly the same way."

Act 3 — Shop by Style

~2 minutes · proves it works on a category that already has products in it

The category: Earthy — an automated collection already live, rule `style-earthy`, currently **12 products**.

The product: Burnt Maple Platter — handle `burnt-maple-platter`, 157 in stock, published, in Platters / Shop / New Arrivals, not currently in Earthy.

- 1 **Tab B:** open `thehomepalette.com.pk/collections/earthy` (or the Earthy tile on the homepage if you did prep 2.2). Note out loud: 12 products, no Burnt Maple Platter.
- 2 **Tab A:** open **Burnt Maple Platter** → Tags → add `style-earthy` → **Save**.
- 3 **Tab B:** hard-refresh. **13 products**, and the Burnt Maple Platter is among them.

SAY

"Same mechanism, on a category that's already running. Adding to it is one tag. Removing from it is deleting that tag. That's the whole system."

Have the tag list to hand. Clients almost always ask "so what are all the tags?" here. Hand them the **Product Tagging Manual** — it lists all six occasions, five styles and twenty-one colours with the exact spelling.

6. If something does not appear — live recovery

Work down this list. Stay calm and narrate it as "let me show you how we'd check this" — the diagnosis is itself a good demo of how simple the system is.

SYMPTOM	DO THIS
Nothing changed after refresh	Hard-refresh: Cmd+Shift+R / Ctrl+F5 . This fixes it nine times out of ten.
Collection still says 0 products	Check the rule reads <i>Product tag · is equal to</i> and the tag is spelled exactly, all lowercase with hyphens. A capital letter or trailing space creates a different tag.
Tag saved but product not in the collection	Confirm you pressed Enter after typing — an untyped-but-unconfirmed tag is not saved. Reopen the product and look for the grey chip.
Colour swatch did not pick up the product	The product almost certainly has a Color / Colour / Shade / Glaze variant option, which overrides colour tags. Switch to the Arabic Mandi Platter, which does not.
Product missing from the storefront entirely	It is unpublished. Check Publishing → Online Store on the product page. Several products in the catalogue are currently unpublished — that is why this runbook names specific verified ones.
Homepage card did not change but the collection page did	The card still has a custom link overriding its collection — prep step 2.2. Fall back to showing the collection URL; the proof is the same.
Product missing from the main Shop page	It needs the <code>online</code> tag, a price above 1, and stock above 1. Not part of this demo, but worth knowing if the client goes exploring.

7. Rollback after the demo

Do this the same day, unless the client asks to keep the changes.

- ☐ Arabic Mandi Platter — remove `copper` and `occasion-eid`
- ☐ Golden Luxe Cutlery Set - 24 Pcs — remove `occasion-eid`
- ☐ Matte Gold Premium Cutlery Set — remove `occasion-eid`
- ☐ Burnt Maple Platter — remove `style-earthy`
- ☐ Delete the **Eid** collection, or keep it if the client wants it — it empties itself once the tags are gone
- ☐ If you demoed on a duplicate theme, delete the duplicate

To remove a tag: open the product → Tags → click the **x** on the chip → **Save**.

Nothing in this demo is destructive. Every step is a tag added to a product or a collection created — both fully reversible in seconds. No product data, pricing or inventory is touched at any point.

8. Questions the client will ask

QUESTION	ANSWER
"How long until it shows on the site?"	Immediately. Colour tags are read live by the theme. Collection rules apply within seconds of saving.
"Can a product be in more than one category?"	Yes, as many as apply — you saw the Mandi platter in Copper and Eid at once.
"What if we spell a tag wrong?"	The product silently does not appear. That is why Shopify autocompletes existing tags — always pick the suggestion rather than retyping. The manual has the exact spellings.
"Can we add a new occasion, like Mother's Day?"	Yes — create an automated collection with rule <code>occasion-mothers-day</code> , tag the products, then add a card to the homepage section in the theme editor. Same five minutes you just watched.
"Can staff do this, or do we need you?"	Staff, entirely. It is one field on the product page. The Product Tagging Manual is written for exactly that.
"What about products that come in several colours?"	Those are handled automatically from the variant options — one listing appears under every colour it sells in, each showing its own photo. No tagging needed.
"How much of the catalogue is tagged today?"	Be straight: Tea Time has 37, Earthy 12, Reactive 8. Everything else needs a first pass — roughly a day of work for the whole catalogue, and it can be done in bulk, collection by collection.